

they will beat the biggies, but my point is that they will be operating in the same market.

This start-up has built only two critical components on its own, and for the rest, it is using open source. It already has clients like banks and financial institutions, which means that critical domains like banking are open to using open source technologies. I think open source offers a certain level of democracy against large software and hardware product companies. The future is certainly going towards open source, leading to a fair balance in the technology market.

Q Are non-tech start-ups also going for open source technologies in a big way?

A. Yes, there are start-ups operating in different domains that use open source technologies in one way or the other. The fact is that young start-ups cannot afford expensive proprietary software.

“There are start-ups operating in different domains that use open source technologies in one way or the other. The fact is that young start-ups cannot afford expensive proprietary software. More importantly, they get a good choice with open source technology, so they happily resort to it.”

More importantly, they get a good choice with open source technology, so they happily resort to it. For instance, we are a financial services start-up but we use open source technology for our emailing system. And we keep looking for open source alternatives wherever they can be deployed.

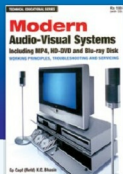
Q So, how does a start-up reach out to you?

A. It actually works both ways. They can reach out to us and we also do keep looking for interesting start-ups. They can come to our website where they can contact us. In our angel meetings, we have something

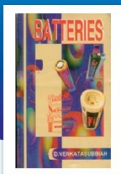
called the ‘idea pitch’ apart from the three formal presentations that we have every month. Here people can come and pitch their ideas and take feedback from the investors present at the meeting. If we like an idea, we invite them back to make a formal presentation. We also attend events related to start-ups where we have interactions with them and keep looking for interesting ideas. As I mentioned earlier, we have partnerships with incubators and student entrepreneurship development cells. So all these, put together, bridge the gap between us and the start-ups. 

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